# Your Special Needs Co-Parenting Report

**Parent completing assessment**

Alex Rivera

**Child**

Ari Rivera

**Assessment date**

2026-07-31

**Needs categories addressed**

- Medical Needs

Your Special Needs Co-Parenting Report summarises the information you provided about your child's medical, educational, developmental, behavioural, or psychological needs. It is designed to help you identify concerns, understand co-parenting challenges, and prepare practical next steps.

This report reflects the perspective of one parent. It is not a diagnosis, custody evaluation, or professional recommendation.

## 2. Your Family Situation

Child: Ari Rivera

### Identified needs

#### Medical Needs

- Chronic medical condition
- Medication schedule
- Specialist appointments

### Professionals currently involved

- Paediatrician
- Specialist physician

### Primary concerns you reported

- Medical Needs: Ari has moderate persistent asthma and needs a daily controller inhaler.

### Decisions that need to be made

- Medical Needs: Schedule the next professional appointment

### Areas of agreement

- Medical Needs: Both parents agree the daily inhaler is non-negotiable.

### Areas of disagreement

- Medical Needs: How to handle sleepovers at friends' houses.

## 3. Areas of Need

### Medical Needs

Concern as described: Ari has moderate persistent asthma and needs a daily controller inhaler.

*Duration: 1 to 3 years · Urgency: Ongoing / stable*

### Current needs

- Chronic medical condition
- Medication schedule
- Specialist appointments
- Sleep or fatigue issues

### Professional recommendation summary

Daily medication, As-needed / rescue medication, Follow-up testing or imaging

## 4. Your Co-Parenting Strengths

*What is already helping your child today.*

- You have professional recommendations in writing, which makes them easier to share consistently.
- Multiple qualified professionals are already involved.

- Professional recommendations are followed in both homes.

## 5. Co-Parenting Challenges

### Medical Needs: Attending appointments and meetings

**What you reported**

On the medical needs pathway you were unsure that this is currently working (attending appointments and meetings).

**Why this may matter to your child**

First-hand attendance reduces mistranslation and helps both parents hear the same clinical or educational language.

**Status: Needs Attention**

**Options to consider**

- Alternate lead attendance for routine visits.
- Attend key decisions (evaluations, IEP meetings, medication reviews) together where possible.
- Use a phone or video option when one parent can't be present.
- Debrief in writing within a day of any missed appointment.

### Medical Needs: Open, calm discussion of this concern

**What you reported**

On the medical needs pathway you were unsure that this is currently working (open, calm discussion of this concern).

**Why this may matter to your child**

When conversations are tense, decisions get delayed and children absorb the tension. A structured channel reduces the emotional cost.

**Status: Needs Attention**

**Options to consider**

- Use email or a co-parenting app so each message has room to think.
- Try BIFF-style messages - brief, informative, friendly, firm.
- Introduce a written agenda for regular check-ins.
- Consider a parenting facilitator or mediator for the recurring topics.

### Medical Needs: Consistent daily routines across homes

**What you reported**

On the medical needs pathway you were unsure that this is currently working (consistent daily routines across homes).

**Why this may matter to your child**

Predictable routines are the strongest support for children with special needs; even small mismatches can escalate anxiety, meltdowns, or missed doses.

**Status: Needs Attention**

**Options to consider**

- Agree on the smallest routine to align first (bedtime, morning, medication).
- Write down the exact steps, times, and who does what.
- Send a photo of the routine to both homes so the child sees it in both places.
- Review after two weeks and adjust together.

### Medical Needs: Sharing updates promptly between homes

**What you reported**

On the medical needs pathway you were unsure that this is currently working (sharing updates promptly between homes).

**Why this may matter to your child**

Delayed information means missed follow-up, duplicate work, and children being asked to be the messenger.

**Status: Needs Attention**

**Options to consider**

- Agree on a single channel for updates (app, email, group thread).
- Set a 24-hour rule for appointment, medication, or school updates.
- Use a shared calendar for all events tied to this concern.
- Automate school and portal notifications to both parents.

## 6. Child Impact Summary

*Possible effects of the current pattern - not assigning blame.*

- The concern you described is affecting the child's daily life; consistency between homes tends to reduce that day-to-day

load.

## 7. Detailed Findings by Category

### Medical Needs

**Status: Developing**

Understanding across parents on this pathway is developing; coordination between homes is developing.

**Recommended parent actions**

- Keep doing what is working; check in monthly to confirm nothing is drifting.

## 8. Parent Alignment Summary

- Disagreement about priorities
- Agreement about the child's needs

*Parents can share the same goal while disagreeing about the method. Naming the type of gap is more useful than trying to be right.*

## 9. Recommended Co-Parenting Structure

### Structured Co-Parenting

Your answers point to some coordination or understanding gaps. A structured approach with written procedures, deadlines, and clearly assigned responsibilities usually reduces friction.

**Safeguards to consider**

- Written communication only for logistics; keep it short and factual.
- Use BIFF-style messages - brief, informative, friendly, firm.
- Written agendas for regular check-ins so both parents come prepared.
- Designate a neutral point person for scheduling appointments.
- Mediation before any nonemergency change to the plan.

*If you experience family violence, coercive control, intimidation, or fear in this co-parenting relationship, please complete the SA CoParents Family Violence & Communication Safety Assessment. Do not accept a joint communication structure that puts you or your child at risk.*

*This report reflects one parent's own answers to the SA CoParents Special Needs Co-Parenting Assessment. It is not a diagnosis, a custody evaluation, a determination of parental fitness, or legal advice. Where appropriate, parents should consult their child's paediatrician, therapist, school, attorney, or another qualified professional.*